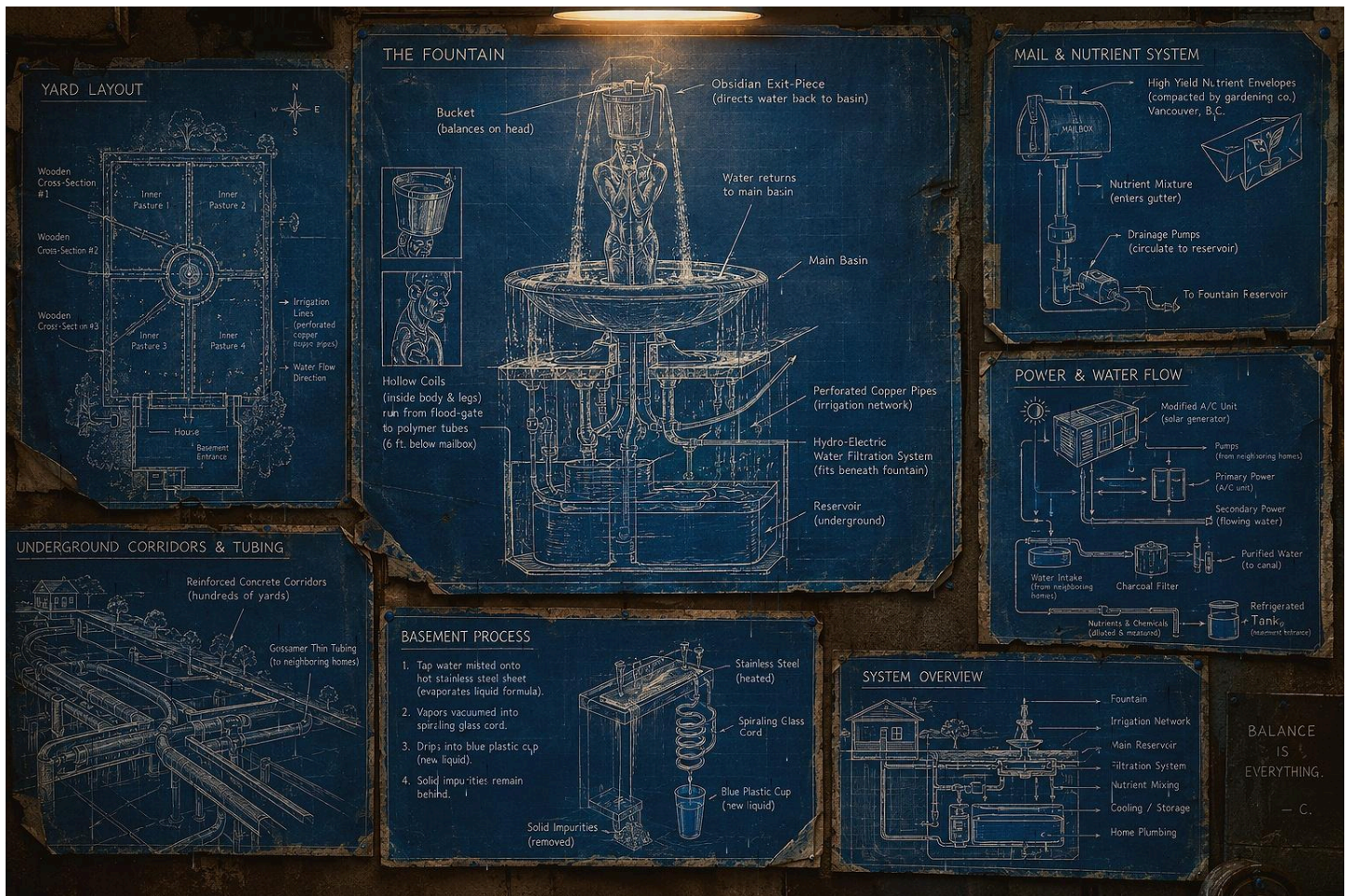


Yards



Chad/Young

There are three wooden cross-sections that divide my lawn into four separate inner pastures, each individually irrigated through a network of perforated copper pipes that extend from a large hydro-electric water filtration system that fits seamlessly into the bottom of the fountain in my yard.

When it rains, there is an underground reservoir which funnels water into a small, obsidian exit-piece which is perched on top of the fountain-pouring liquids back into the main basin from a bucket which is balanced on its head.

(A heavy web of hollow coils make up the inside body and legs of this statuette, and they run from a flood-gate near the exiting water at the bucket.. to a bundle of polymer tubes 6 feet beneath my mailbox.)

The few bits of mail I do receive are actually high yield nutrients which have been compacted into the shape of envelopes by a high tech gardening company located outside of Vancouver B.C. When the mailman drops these envelopes into the gutter, he is actually releasing carefully measured amounts of chemicals into a field of underground drainage pumps that circulate the mixture back into the reservoir underneath the fountain.

There are times when I am lying in bed watching the ceiling fan spin its shadows into the open doors of my bedroom- when I'll wearily contemplate the importance of my work. And as my mind wanders with the shades of grey and black on the walls, I am sometimes tempted to run into the streets screaming my secrets to all of those who would listen, hoping beyond anything that some random passersby could validate the terrible things which I have done. It's during these times when I am most vulnerable to the pressures and influences of the outside world.

My home in this place is nothing more than a diversion for my life below. The walls and shelves of my living room are decorated with portraits of families that I have never seen nor spoken to, and the kitchen pantry is stocked only with foods essential to my own survival. The things that hold value for others, their television sets and high speed internet connections, their cash and jewelry and precious loved ones... none of these things reflect well in the fountain

In addition to the intricate waterways beneath my
home, there are
several
hundred yards of reinforced concrete corridors that
spiral a
considerable
distance beyond the restrictive boundaries of my

property. These
distances
are more than tripled in the bundles of gossamer thin
tubing which
furtively
occupy several of the corridors that cluster
underneath my neighboring
homes
and gardens. Much could be said of the upkeep to these
structures,
which, if
left intended could lead to an entropy of the system,
and perhaps more
importantly, to a stagnation of the chemicals which
the system so
studiously
maintains. I have little doubt that without constant
supervision, the
delicate balances of these devices would cease to
perform their
intended
functions, and begin to operate redundantly on their
own accord.

On power, there is the air-conditioning unit on the
side of my home
that
has been modified to double as a sort of solar
generator. The pumps
transferring water from the neighboring homes are run
from both the
primary
power of this unit and the secondary power of the
flowing water itself.

This
steady intake of water into the main system is
purified through a
charcoal

filter then sent directly to a solitary canal on the
opposite end of
the
fountain. It is from here that the nearby reservoir of
brewing chemicals
and
nutrients are properly diluted and measured carefully
into injectable
doses.

After this, they are quickly transferred to a
refrigerated holding tank
near
the entrance to my basement.
It is only now that the fountain is able relinquish
control of the
system
to the local plumbing of my home. This control is
frequently botched
by the
design of the primitive structures hydro-architecture,
but any
modifications
to the upper levels of my compound would only draw
unneeded attention
from
the outside world. As it is, two feet beneath the
floor of the
basement, tap
water faucet pumps mist the cooled mixture onto a
white hot-sheet of
stainless steel, thus, evaporating the liquid formula
and leaving the
solid
impurities behind. This vapor is vacuumed into a
spiraling glass cord
which
drips the new liquid into a blue plastic cup on my

windowsill.

I will sometimes observe the contents
of that cup,
curiously holding it up to the sun- and swishing the
liquids into a
whirlpool.

And at the end of the day when I have
nothing left to do,

I
will often wonder at
what
it means-

what
the
fluid actually represents.

It seems the only things I do know anymore, are that
when I step
underground, I am proud-

that when I pour water into a glass,

I am happy,

and that when I shower in the evening with the idea of
another day
before
me,

I will think of the fountain,
and smile.